

Session 2: Participant UX & Organizer Flow

Hacksathon.com — Product Design Document

Final version — all decisions incorporated. Ready for Cursor.

Standing Decisions

Naming:

- **Hacksathon.com** — the platform brand (one word, the domain)
- **Hacks-a-Thon** — the event format companies run (hyphenated everywhere else)
- A company's event is always "[Company Name] Hacks-a-Thon" — pre-populated default, always pushed for searchability and brand spread

Module visibility:

- Internal planning tool names (ZERO.Prmptr, EDIT.Prmptr) are infrastructure — never visible to participants
- **IdeaLab is the exception:** visible, named platform area — participants submit ideas there, their card lives there, the gallery lives there
- Block numbers and internal module names never appear in participant-facing UI

Format and philosophy:

- Event timeline is fully flexible — organizers set their own dates. Two weeks is the recommended default; one to four weeks all work. Platform enforces nothing.
- Participants are encouraged to work ahead and build more than the blocked sessions. Blocks are a guaranteed floor, not a ceiling.
- Time-blocking on participant calendars is how the format works. Platform facilitates this with Add to Calendar links. No in-platform session timer needed.
- Self-serve is non-negotiable. No feature assumes Nick's direct involvement post-beta.
- Demo Environment (pre-populated with Seven2 data) is the primary pre-purchase experience — no time limit, no credit card.

Planning conversation:

- Generates one consolidated PRD document (not multiple separate files)

- PRD incorporates: what it does, who it's for, design direction, features (core + out of scope), user flows, done state, and build notes
- Conversation stays open after PRD is generated — participants can return at any time to describe changes; AI updates relevant sections without restarting
- No formal "Revise mode" — just an ongoing conversation with the existing plan loaded as context

Organizer controls:

- Block names customizable — inline edit during date setup
- Block 05 and Block 06 (build days) independently toggleable
- Any date editable mid-event
- Award category names customizable — especially "Most [Company] Energy"
- Voting interface only opens when organizer manually triggers it, after marking all Showcase sessions complete
- AI generates reflection summary paragraph — Program Operator reviews before publishing

Language:

- "Starter Prompt" — what participants see (not "Your First Prompt")
- "Showcase Showdown" — the final live session
- "The Hacky Awards" — awards ceremony
- "IdeaLab" — visible, named idea submission and gallery area
- "PRD" or "Your Project Brief" — the planning output document

1. Naming Conventions & Language Map

Platform vs. Event Format

Context	Term	Example
Platform brand	Hacksathon.com	"Run your Hacks-a-Thon on Hacksathon.com"
Event format	Hacks-a-Thon	"The Acme Hacks-a-Thon"
Pre-populated event name	[Company] Hacks-a-Thon	"Meridian Hacks-a-Thon"
Vanity URL	hacksathon.com/[company]	hacksathon.com/meridian

Always push toward "Hacks-a-Thon" for events. When an employee tells a friend they did the "Meridian Hacks-a-Thon," that's searchable and tied back to the platform.

Participant-Facing Language Map

Internal Name	Participant Sees	Where
IdeaLab	" IdeaLab " (visible, named)	Block 01, idea gallery, idea cards, emails
ZERO.Prmptr	The planning conversation	Block 03 — no label needed
EDIT.Prmptr	"Edit Your Plan"	Post-planning edit action
Planning output	"Your PRD" / "Your Project Brief"	Document heading
Starter Prompt	"Starter Prompt"	Below the PRD
The platform	"Hacksathon"	General references
Block numbers	ZERO / 01 / 02 / 03 / 04 / 05 / 06 / FINAL / +01 / +02	Participant checklist

UI Language Principles

- Verb-led where possible: "Submit Your Idea", "Plan Your Build", "Share Your Work"
 - Possessive where it adds warmth: "Your Idea", "Your PRD", "Your Plan"
 - Never jargon: no "module", "tool", "feature", "input field"
 - The planning AI has no branded name — the conversation is the experience
-

2. Organizer Flow — The Full Journey

Phase 1: Discovery

Entry points: direct outreach from Nick (beta), referral, organic search, paid social, banner ads.

Regardless of entry point: every visitor can self-service the entire journey from discovery through purchase. No demo call, no sales process, no gating.

Key asset — overview video: Nick produces a short overview video (2–3 minutes) explaining what a Hacks-a-Thon is, what participants experience, and what organizers get. Lives on the homepage and in the Demo Environment. Essential for cold paid traffic.

The Demo Environment — pre-populated event using Seven2 reference data. Shows both organizer dashboard and participant views. No account, no credit card, no expiration.

Phase 2: Purchase

1. Company name
2. Estimated participant count (pricing: \$995 base, \$30/seat over 25, \$1,745 ceiling at 50)
3. Promo/discount code field (day one — required for affiliate attribution)
4. Stripe payment

After purchase: confirmation screen + email with "What happens next" summary and direct link into setup.

Phase 3: Event Setup (6 Steps)

Progress saved throughout — completable in one sitting or across multiple sessions.

Step 1 — The Basics

- **Event name** — pre-populated as "[Company Name] Hacks-a-Thon" from checkout. Editable, but we always push the default.
 - **Vanity URL** — organizer sets slug: [hacksathon.com/\[companyslug\]](https://hacksathon.com/[companyslug]). Availability check, auto-suggest if taken. Becomes the public results page URL.
 - **Logo upload** — optional. PNG or SVG, square or horizontal, minimum 200px wide, transparent background preferred. Displayed within Hacksathon.com design constraints — no uploaded logo can break the layout. If no logo: company name as styled text. Both look good.
 - **Program Operator** — if buyer isn't the day-to-day runner, enter Program Operator email here. They receive an invitation with full setup permissions. Executive Sponsor retains visibility.
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Step 2 — Set Your Dates + Block Names

Three anchor dates:

- Event Kickoff date
- Shark Tank date (auto-suggested: end of Week 1)
- Showcase Showdown date (auto-suggested: end of Week 2)

Timeline is fully flexible. Auto-suggestions reflect the two-week default. Every date is editable. One to four weeks all work.

Date changes mid-event: Any block date is editable from the organizer dashboard during the live event. Participants see updated dates automatically.

Multiple Showcase Showdown sessions: Platform calculates estimated session count (~6 min/participant: 3-min demo + 2-min Q&A + ~1-min transition). Example: "With 18 participants, plan for approximately two 60-minute sessions." Organizer sets dates for each session.

Optional blocks — toggled here:

- Block 05 (second build day) — default: enabled
- Block 06 (third build day) — default: enabled

Block name customization: Edit icon next to each default name. Default stays as placeholder. Most organizers leave defaults; some rename to fit their culture.

Add to Calendar: Each block has an Add to Calendar icon generating an ICS / Google Calendar link. Organizer forwards to team for time-blocking. This is how the format works — calendar is the clock.

Step 3 — Set Up Your Slack Channel

Guidance panel — not a required form.

- Recommended channel name: [#\[company\]-hacks-a-thon](#)
- Copyable prompts to seed engagement (e.g., "What's your idea? Drop it here before the Shark Tank 🦈")
- Reminder to pin the IdeaLab link and build tool resources

This channel is not a scheduled check-in — it is the ambient social layer of the entire event. Runs from Kickoff through Showcase and beyond. Participants post questions, share screenshots, get unstuck, encourage each other. Organizer seeds it; community sustains it.

Organizer enters their Slack URL here. Participants see a persistent "Questions? Ideas? Head to Slack →" card in their event home throughout the event, linking directly to the channel.

Step 4 — Add Participants

Organizer enters participant emails one per line (no CSV — too much friction). Platform generates a unique event join link + short event code. Each participant receives both in their invitation email.

Join experience: Click magic link → land directly in event home, already associated with the correct event. No password required. Event code is a fallback for link expiry or device changes.

Dashboard status: Invited / Joined / Active (started at least one block).

Step 5 — Customize Your Welcome

1. **Welcome message** — rich-text field, pre-populated with a strong default leading with the passion project framing. Organizer edits on top — doesn't start from blank.
 2. **Welcome video** — optional. Organizer pastes a video URL (Loom, YouTube, Vimeo) that plays in the participant's event home. Separate from Nick's platform overview video, which is always available for organizers to share pre-kickoff as a "what is this?" explainer.
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Step 6 — Review & Launch

Summary screen: event name, vanity URL, dates, participant count, optional block status, schedule preview. One "Launch Event" button.

After launch: accepted participants can access their event home. Organizer sees live dashboard.

Phase 4: Running the Event (Ongoing Dashboard)

Progress Overview — per-participant block completion: not started / in progress / complete. Color-coded. No per-project content visible — only completion status.

Shark Tank View — surfaces near Shark Tank date. All IdeaLab entries in a projectable card view: project name, one-line description, participant name. Session Host displays on screen during the live session.

Showcase Showdown View — gallery of all projects: participant name, project name, live URL, project screenshot. Projectable. Multiple sessions filter by session group.

Voting Control — Hacky Awards voting does not open until organizer manually marks all Showcase sessions complete, then manually triggers the reveal. The reveal is a moment — organizer controls the timing.

Messaging — organizer can send a platform notification to all participants (renders as banner in event home). For logistics and encouragement — not a full messaging system.

Phase 5: Post-Event

Public Results Page

After the event wraps, organizer is prompted to publish their results page at [hacksathon.com/\[company\]](https://hacksathon.com/[company]). Off by default; organizer toggles live when ready. Modeled on the Seven2 Hacks-a-Thon site. Includes:

- Event name, logo, summary
- All participant projects (pulled from IdeaLab entries — participants are responsible for keeping their entry updated: live URL, final screenshot, final description)
- Hacky Awards results
- AI-generated reflection summary (Program Operator reviews and approves before publishing)

Once live: shareable, designed for LinkedIn. Organic acquisition — when a company publishes their results page, it drives awareness back to Hacksathon.com.

AI Reflection Summary — after all reflections submitted, platform generates a short summary paragraph. Tone: warm, specific, celebratory. Program Operator reviews, can regenerate, can edit before approving for the public page.

What's Next for Participants — post-event panel in event home:

- Reminder to finalize IdeaLab entry (feeds the public results page)
 - Encouragement to keep building
 - Prompt to add the project to their portfolio or share it
-

3. Participant Journey — The 10 Blocks

All 10 blocks visible as a numbered checklist from day one — past blocks complete, current block active, future blocks upcoming. Seeing the full arc gives people a sense of the finish line and lets people who want to move ahead do so.

Block ZERO — Kickoff (*Live session*)

Participant receives invitation → clicks magic link → lands on event home.

Event home shows:

- Event name + company logo (or styled company name)
- Welcome message — passion project framing goes first, always
- Optional welcome video
- Full 10-block checklist — ZERO marked active
- Slack channel link (persistent throughout the event)

Block ZERO marked complete by organizer after the live session, or automatically once the kickoff date passes.

Block 01 — Sprint to the IdeaLab (*Idea submission*)

Participant submits their idea card:

- **Project name** (required)
- **What does it do?** — one sentence (required)
- **Category** — For fun / Solve a real problem / Work tool / Something weird (optional)
- **Tell us more** — free text (optional)
- **Project status** — In Progress / Completed (participant updates this throughout the event)

After submitting: idea card is live in the IdeaLab gallery. Confirmation screen shows the card back to them. Below: "Next up — Shark Tank on [date]. You'll pitch this in 60 seconds. Come ready."

IdeaLab gallery (all submitted ideas) is visible to everyone in the event from the first submission. Creates shared energy before the Shark Tank.

Block 02 — Shark Tank (*Live session*)

Not a platform experience — a calendar event. The platform supports it two ways:

Before: A Shark Tank Prep panel appears after Block 01 is complete. Format reminder: 60 seconds, one sentence pitch, no slides, feedback is fast and friendly. **A sample video from the Seven2 Hacks-a-Thon Shark Tank is embedded here** — seeing a real non-technical person make it work removes fear better than any written description.

After: Participants can return to update their IdeaLab entry if pitch feedback changed their direction. Soft prompt, not required.

Organizer marks Block 02 complete from the dashboard after the session.

Block 03 — The Blueprint (*AI planning conversation*)

After Shark Tank, the next open block is The Blueprint.

Participant sees: a focused screen with a short framing message about why planning before building matters, and a "Start Planning" button.

Clicking it opens the **planning conversation** — see Section 4 for the full spec.

The conversation produces one **PRD** (Project Brief / planning document), rendered cleanly on screen. Below it: the **Starter Prompt** with step-by-step instructions for the first build. The PRD is downloadable as a single .md file.

The conversation stays open after the PRD is generated. Participants can return at any point — after Shark Tank feedback, mid-build, any time — describe a change, and the AI updates the relevant PRD sections without restarting.

Block 03 is the only hard gate. Participants cannot proceed to Block 04 until the planning conversation is complete and a PRD exists.

Block 04 — Here We Go! (*First build session*)

Platform shows a focused screen: PRD (collapsed, one click away), Starter Prompt (with Copy button and instructions still accessible), short note of encouragement.

No session timer — calendar blocking is the clock. Participants are free to build for as long as they want. The block is a guaranteed start, not a limit.

Block 05 — Keep Building (*Second build session — optional*)

Same as Block 04. Organizer enables or disables during setup.

Block 06 — Final Push (*Third build session — optional*)

Same pattern. The flex block. Default: enabled.

Block FINAL — Showcase Showdown (*Live session — may be multiple*)

Before: Participants see a demo prep checklist:

- Confirm or add live URL in IdeaLab
- Upload final screenshot (becomes card image on public results page)
- Demo format: 3 minutes to show, 2 minutes for Q&A — "Open your app. Walk through it like you're showing a friend."

During: Organizer uses Showcase Showdown view in dashboard — projectable gallery. Multiple sessions filter by session group.

After: Organizer marks each session complete. Only after all sessions are marked complete does voting become available to trigger.

Block +01 — The Hacky Awards (*Async voting*)

Voting opens when organizer manually triggers it. Participants vote in each category.

Default categories (all names customizable):

- Best in Show
- Shut Up and Take My Money
- Best Execution
- Most Creative Idea
- Best Shark Tank Pitch
- Most [Company Name] Energy ← organizer renames to fit their culture, or replaces with a custom award

Results hidden until organizer manually reveals them. The reveal is a moment.

When the organizer reveals results, the event locks. Participants can no longer edit their PRD, update their IdeaLab entry, or make any changes. Everything becomes read-only. The public results page, if the organizer publishes it, is what lives on.

Block +02 — Reflections (*Async form*)

5–7 questions. Default set from Seven2 (organizer can edit):

1. What surprised you most about this experience?
2. What do you wish you'd known before your very first prompt?
3. What did you discover about your own creative process?
4. Did this unlock any ideas you're actually going to pursue?
5. Did this change how you think about AI or what's possible for you creatively?
6. What advice would you give to a nervous first-timer?
7. What one thing would help future participants jump in faster?

Responses visible to Program Operator only. AI generates a summary paragraph for the organizer to review and optionally publish to the public results page.

4. The Planning Conversation — Full Spec

The planning conversation engine is a shared module — every change applies simultaneously to Hacksathon.com Block 03 and the standalone ZERO.Prmpr product.

Core Principles

The planning conversation is a real conversation — not a form with a conversational skin. The AI:

- Asks one question at a time
- Acknowledges and reflects back each answer before moving on
- Uses the project name throughout once established
- Acts as a genuine **thinking partner** — after each answer, the AI can offer follow-up observations, flag scope risk, connect current answers to prior ones, or propose angles the participant hasn't considered. These follow-ups are optional and never block advancement.
- Maintains full conversation memory across all five steps — no step is stateless
- **Stays open after the PRD is generated** — participants can return at any point, describe a change, and the AI updates the relevant PRD sections. No restart. No formal mode switch. The conversation simply continues with the existing plan loaded as context.
- Sounds like a smart, curious, direct friend — not a product manager running a requirements intake

What the AI may offer in optional follow-ups (max 2 per step):

- Noticing when an answer sounds like two ideas ("this might be two separate things — which is the core one?")
- Connecting the current step to something said earlier ("you mentioned your user is a working parent — does that change the design direction you're describing?")
- Surfacing things the participant hasn't thought about yet ("have you considered what happens when a user wants to revisit a past entry?")
- Offering a concrete variation ("another angle: what if instead of X, you framed it as Y?")
- Gently flagging scope risk ("this is ambitious for a first build — want to sketch a smaller version 1?")

What the AI must not do:

- Ask more than 2 follow-up observations or questions at a time

- Repeat answers back without adding value
- Block advancement to the next step
- Be sycophantic ("Great idea!")

Conversation Memory — The `planningSession` Object

Every API call receives the full prior conversation history. No step is a fresh call. The `planningSession` object persists through the entire flow and beyond — post-PRD revision exchanges are appended to the same history.

```
JavaScript
planningSession = {
  projectName: string,
  ideaId: string,           // from IdeaLab entry if available
  buildTool: string,       // from event config (Lovable, Cursor, Bolt, etc.)
  conversationHistory: [
    { role: 'system', content: systemPrompt },
    { role: 'assistant', content: step1Question },
    { role: 'user', content: step1Answer },
    { role: 'assistant', content: step1ReflectionAndFollowUps },
    { role: 'user', content: step1FollowUpResponse }, // if any
    { role: 'assistant', content: step2Question },
    // ... continues through all 5 steps and any post-PRD exchanges
  ],
  stepAnswers: {
    step1: string,           // what it does
    step2: string,           // who it's for
    step3: {                 // design direction
      vibe: string,
      referenceUrl: string,
      colorNotes: string
    },
    step4: string,           // the one thing (scope)
    step5: string            // done looks like
  },
  prdGenerated: boolean,
  prdId: string | null
}
```

Each step transition passes the full `conversationHistory` forward and includes an internal system note: *"The user has confirmed they're ready to move on from Step N. Do not revisit Step N. Build on it."* Each new step opens with a question that demonstrates awareness of what came before.

Entry Scenario A: Participant Has an IdeaLab Entry

System pre-loads project name and one-line description. AI opens with that context — no re-asking.

Opening:

"You've got [Project Name] in the IdeaLab — let's build your plan before you start building. I'm going to ask you five questions. Nothing technical, just about what you're making and who it's for. Tell me more about [Project Name] — what does it actually do? Explain it like you're telling a friend."

Entry Scenario B: No IdeaLab Entry

Opening:

"Before you start building, let's take a few minutes to think through your project. I'll ask you some questions — you just talk, and I'll help shape it into a plan. First: what do you want to call it? Even a rough working title is fine."

Once they provide a name, the AI uses it from that point forward.

The Five Planning Steps

One question at a time. After each answer: acknowledge, reflect, optionally offer 1–2 follow-up observations or questions. A clearly visible "I'm ready to move on →" action is always available — the participant advances when they're ready.

Step 1 — What it does

"In your own words, what does [Project Name] do? Tell me like you'd explain it to a friend."

Reflection pattern: "So [Project Name] is basically [paraphrase]. Got it. [Optional: one observation that could sharpen this — scope risk, implied feature, interesting angle.]"

Step 2 — Who it's for

"Who's the first real person you'd show this to when it's done? Tell me about them — not a demographic, just someone specific."

The "specific someone" framing produces better scope decisions than "target user." The AI carries this person's description forward — by Step 3, it connects: "given that she's a traveling parent who's tired at end of day, what should [Project Name] feel like the moment she opens it?"

Step 3 — What it feels like (*Design direction — critical for creative audiences*)

"When someone opens [Project Name] for the first time, what should it feel like? Name a vibe, describe an aesthetic, reference a website you like — or say 'it should feel like [Brand X] but for [Person Y].'"

Design direction was the #1 friction point at Seven2. This question makes the visual translation explicit and gives permission to use references. The AI stores vibe, reference URL, and color notes separately in the session object. It may offer: "You mentioned [aesthetic] — have you seen how [reference site] handles [element]? That might be a useful anchor in your build tool."

Step 4 — The one thing (*Scope guard*)

"If [Project Name] could only do one thing when it launches — just one — what is that thing? Finish this sentence: '[Project Name] helps [someone] do [one thing].'"

If they include "and also," the AI holds the line: "Let's keep it to one thing for now. What's the most important one? We can plan a v2 — starting focused is how the best first builds happen."

If scope sounds ambitious: "Based on what you've described, there might be a smaller version 1 worth defining. Want to spend a minute on that before we move on?"

Step 5 — Done looks like

"Last one: how will you know when it's done enough to demo? What's the minimum that has to actually work for you to feel good showing it at the Showcase Showdown?"

The Output — One PRD + Starter Prompt

After Step 5, the AI generates **one comprehensive PRD** — not assembled from raw answers, but synthesized by a final API call that receives the full `conversationHistory`. The `stepAnswers` fields are the data layer; the AI synthesis is the readable output.

Transition message:

"You've got a plan. Here's your [Project Name] PRD."

The PRD — [Project Name]

All planning information lives in one document. One file to download, one file to attach to Lovable.

None

[Project Name] – Project Brief

🎯 What It Does

[1-2 paragraph synthesis, expanded and contextualized beyond the raw answer]

👤 Who It's For

[Their specific someone, with enough context to make real design decisions from]

✨ How It Should Feel

[Aesthetic direction verbatim + reference sites or color notes from Step 3]

[2-3 sentences the participant can paste directly into Lovable when asking for design changes]

⚡ The One Thing

[Project Name] helps [X] do [Y].

🔧 Features

****Core (v1)****

[The one thing expanded into what it actually means to build – drawn from Steps 1, 4, and 5]

****Supporting Features****

[2-4 features that logically support the core, drawn from the conversation]

****Out of Scope for v1****

[Anything that came up but belongs in v2 – populated from the scope guard step]

🚶 How Users Move Through It

****Primary Flow****

1. [Step]

2. [Step]

3. [Step]

→ Outcome: [what the user gets]


```
**Edge Cases to Consider**
[1-2 edge cases the AI surfaced or the participant mentioned]

## ✅ Done When
[Their Step 5 answer – what has to work for the Showcase Showdown to feel like a win]

## 🔍 Build Notes

**Things Worth Thinking About**
[2-3 tensions or open questions noticed across the conversation –
e.g., "Your target user is very specific but your done state sounds
designed for anyone. Worth resolving before you start."]

**Assumptions to Watch**
[The biggest bets embedded in the plan –
e.g., "This assumes users will input data manually. What if they won't?"]

**v1 / v2 Split** *(only shown if scope risk was flagged during Step 4)*
[What belongs in the first build vs. what to save]
```

The Starter Prompt — With Step-by-Step Instructions

Prominently below the PRD. The first prompt into a build tool is the scariest moment for a non-technical participant — the platform makes this completely explicit.

Starter Prompt

This is how you kick off your build in Lovable (or Cursor or Bolt).

Step 1 — Download your PRD using the button below.

Step 2 — Open your build tool and start a new project.

Step 3 — Paste the Starter Prompt below as your very first message.

Step 4 — Attach your PRD file. In Lovable, click the paperclip icon and upload it. This gives the AI everything it needs to build the right thing from the start.

Step 5 — Hit send. You're building.

[Copy Starter Prompt] [Download PRD]

None

I'm building an app called [Project Name].

Here's what it is: [1-2 sentence synthesis]

It's for: [their specific someone]

The one thing it needs to do: [Project Name] helps [X] do [Y].

Design direction: [aesthetic vibe + any reference sites]

For this first build, only [done state] needs to work.

Start there and nothing else. Don't add features I haven't asked for.

I'm attaching my full PRD – please read it before you start building.

Post-PRD Revision (Ongoing Conversation)

After the PRD is generated, the conversation stays open and the full plan stays loaded as context. The participant simply comes back and describes what changed:

"I got feedback at Shark Tank and want to cut the social sharing feature — I just want this to be personal use only."

The AI acknowledges the change, identifies which PRD sections are affected, proposes the specific updates, and regenerates the Starter Prompt if needed. Unaffected sections stay intact. No restart. No re-answering questions that haven't changed.

Transition message for post-PRD conversation:

"Got it — cutting social sharing and keeping [Project Name] personal. That changes a few things in the Features section and simplifies the User Flow. Here's what the updated PRD looks like..."

Tone Reference

During the five steps: ✅ "You've got [Project Name] in the IdeaLab — let's build your plan."

✅ "So [Project Name] is basically a bedtime story app that personalizes to the child. Got it. One thing I'm wondering — is the story the product, or is the routine?" ✅ "That's really useful design

direction. 'Calm but confident, like Linear but warmer' — I know exactly what you mean. Any reference sites?" ☒ "Let's keep it to one thing for now. What's the most important one? We can name the v2 stuff in a minute." ☒ "This scope is ambitious for a first build. Want to sketch a smaller version 1 before we move on?"

Post-PRD revision: ☒ "Got it — you want to cut the social sharing feature and keep [Project Name] focused on personal use only. That changes a few things in the Features section and simplifies the User Flow. Here's what the updated PRD looks like..."

Never: ☒ "Please describe the core function of your application in one sentence." ☒ "What is the target user demographic for this product?" ☒ "Are you ready to begin?" ☒ "Great idea! Let's keep going." ☒ "Please provide visual design specifications."

5. The IdeaLab — Feature Detail

IdeaLab is a visible, named platform area:

- Where participants submit their idea (Block 01)
- Where all event ideas are displayed as a gallery (visible to everyone)
- Where each project card lives and gets updated throughout the event
- Data source for the Shark Tank View, Showcase Showdown View, and public results page

Each participant gets one IdeaLab entry — not multiple. Their one project is what they pitch, plan, build, and demo. If their direction changes after the Shark Tank, they update their existing entry rather than creating a new one.

Project status (participant-controlled on their own card):

- **In Progress** — default on submission
- **Completed** — participant can only set this after uploading a final screenshot and adding their live URL. These two fields are required to mark complete.

IdeaLab gallery is visible to all participants from the first submission. Participants can see each other's project names and descriptions — not each other's PRDs (those are private).

Participants are responsible for keeping their entry updated: live URL, final screenshot, final description. The post-event What's Next prompt and the Showcase Showdown prep checklist both reinforce this. It feeds directly into the public results page.

6. Implementation Notes for Cursor

1. **String audit** — Search all participant-facing strings for "ZERO.Prmptr", "EDIT.Prmptr", "Demo Day", "Your First Prompt". Replace per the language map in Section 1. Note: "IdeaLab" is now visible and correct in participant-facing UI — do not hide it.
2. **Planning conversation system prompt** — Update to reflect Section 4: use project name from IdeaLab if available, ask one question at a time, reflect answers back before each next question, offer strategic thinking (max 2 follow-ups per step), follow the 5-step structure. Remove any "Are you ready?" gating.
3. **Scenario detection** — Check for IdeaLab entry. If yes: Scenario A (project name + description pre-loaded). If no: Scenario B (name-first cold open).
4. **Conversation persistence** — The `planningSession` object must persist after PRD generation. The conversation window stays open and appends post-PRD exchanges to the same history. This is how revision works — no separate mode.
5. **PRD rendering** — Output renders as a single clean document with the section structure defined in Section 4. Editable via rich-text interface ("Edit Your Plan"). Not a chat transcript.
6. **Starter Prompt** — Appears below every PRD. Synthesizes brief fields into a build-tool-ready paragraph. Includes step-by-step usage instructions (see Section 4 for exact copy). One-click copy button. "Download PRD" button alongside it. Regenerates when PRD is edited.
7. **Event name pre-population** — "[Company Name] Hacks-a-Thon" using company name from checkout.
8. **Vanity URL** — Text input with availability check and auto-suggest. Becomes the public results page URL.
9. **Logo upload** — PNG or SVG. Minimum 200px wide. Displayed within Hacksathon.com design constraints. Text fallback if no logo.
10. **Block date editing** — All block dates editable mid-event from organizer dashboard. Not locked after launch.
11. **Multiple Showcase sessions** — Prompt organizer to schedule multiple sessions if participant count exceeds ~10. Display estimated time calculation (~6 min/participant).

12. **Add to Calendar** — Each block in organizer schedule view generates ICS / Google Calendar link. Organizer forwards to participants.
 13. **Voting gates** — Voting only becomes available after organizer marks all Showcase sessions complete. Organizer then manually triggers the reveal.
 14. **Award category customization** — All category names editable. "Most [Company Name] Energy" defaults to company name.
 15. **AI reflection summary** — Generate via Claude API after all reflections submitted. Warm, celebratory, specific. Program Operator reviews and approves before publishing.
 16. **Public results page** — Off by default. Organizer toggles live. Pulls from IdeaLab entries, awards results, and approved AI reflection summary.
 17. **Promo/discount code** — Present on checkout from day one. Per-code attribution tracking. Managed from Murtopolis admin.
 18. **Participant join flow** — Magic link drops participant into event home with correct event association. Event code as fallback.
 19. **Session timer** — Do not build. Remove if currently built. Calendar blocking is the mechanism.
 20. **Block 02 Shark Tank sample video** — Embed a Seven2 Hacks-a-Thon pitch video in the Block 02 Shark Tank Prep panel. Nick to provide the clip.
 21. **ZERO.Prmptr shared module** — All changes to the planning conversation engine apply simultaneously to Hacksathon.com Block 03 and the standalone ZERO.Prmptr product. Structure the component accordingly from the first file decision.
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7. Open Questions

- ☒ **Hacksathon vs. Hacks-a-Thon** — confirmed: Hacksathon.com (platform), Hacks-a-Thon (event format)
- ☒ **ZERO.Prmptr document types** — confirmed: one consolidated PRD incorporating all planning information
- ☒ **Revise mode** — confirmed: not a formal mode, just an ongoing conversation that stays open post-PRD
- ☒ **Third IdeaLab project status** — confirmed: In Progress (default) and Completed only. Completed requires screenshot upload + live URL before it can be set.

- ☒ **One IdeaLab entry per participant** — confirmed: each participant has one project entry. Direction changes update the existing entry, not create a new one.
- ☒ **Post-event What's Next path** — resolved by the one-and-done model. Event locks when organizer reveals results — no further edits to PRDs or IdeaLab entries. Everything becomes read-only. The public results page is what lives on.
- ☐ **Platform overview video** — planned, Nick produces post-launch. Build with a placeholder slot on the homepage and in the Demo Environment ready to receive it.
- ☐ **Block 02 sample video** — planned, Nick provides a Seven2 Shark Tank clip post-launch. Build the Block 02 Shark Tank Prep panel with a placeholder slot ready to receive it.

End of Session 2: Participant UX & Organizer Flow Status: Ready for Cursor Next: Session 3 — TBD